

WINE MAKING

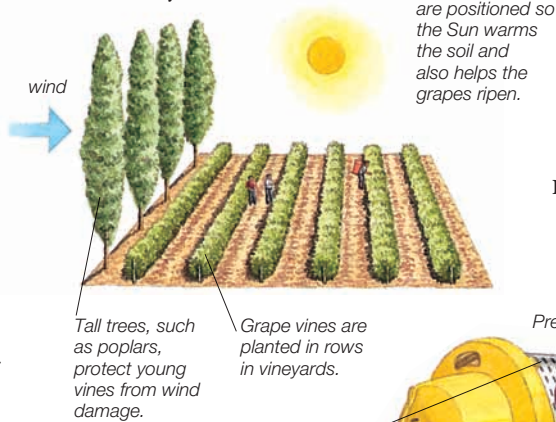
France produces about a fifth of the world's wine, and vineyards are a feature of the French landscape. Wine is made from the juice of black or white grapes (which are actually red or pale green in color). Although juice was once extracted by people trampling on the picked grapes, today's methods are generally more modern. There are several processes in the production of wine, including fermentation, which mixes a natural yeast on the grape skin with the sugar in the grape. Pressing grapes using a modern press is shown here.



IMMIGRATION

France has about 6 million immigrants, mainly Muslims from Morocco, Tunisia, and Algeria – France's former colonies in North Africa. People also arrive from Italy, Spain, and Poland in the hope of finding work. Immigrants often face problems such as discrimination, unemployment, and poor housing.

A French vineyard



The rows of vines are positioned so the Sun warms the soil and also helps the grapes ripen.



Black or white grapes can be used to make white wine. It is the skins that give red wine its color.

Pneumatic press

Black grapes go through a crusher that tears off the stalks and pumps the grapes into the press.

Air pumped in here to inflate rubber bag

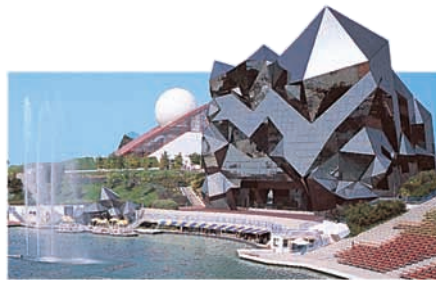
The press revolves to move the grapes around.

As the bag fills with air it gently pushes grapes against the cylinder to press out the juice.

Pressed grapes

Trough to collect grape juice before it is turned into wine

Wine is usually drunk from a tall glass that holds in the flavor.



WORLD OF MOVIES

The film industry began in France in 1895 when the Lumiere brothers showed a film to an audience of 33. Today France is one of the leading makers of internationally acclaimed films. The crystal-shaped Kinemax in Poitiers has 10 different theaters and one of the biggest screens in Europe.

MONACO

A TINY COUNTRY ON THE Mediterranean coast, Monaco lies close to the Italian border. The heart of the country is the sophisticated city of Monte-Carlo, famous for its gambling casinos and car racing Grand Prix. Monaco is an independent principality, ruled for more than 700 years by the Grimaldi family. Only a small part of the population is originally from Monaco; more than half the people are citizens of France.



TOURISM

Monaco's warm climate and glamorous image attract thousands of tourists. Many rich people, with yachts moored in the old harbor, choose to live there because it has a low tax rate. Monaco is also a major international business center.

ANDORRA

HIGH IN THE PYRENEES MOUNTAINS, on the border between France and Spain, nestles the country of Andorra. The country is nominally ruled jointly by the president of France and the bishop of Urgel in northeastern Spain. Catalan is the official language, although many people also speak French and Spanish. The country's only large town is the capital city, Andorra la Vella.



THE PYRENEES

The main source of income in Andorra is tourism. Many people come to ski in the Pyrenees, although the only road between France and Spain is often blocked by heavy snow in winter.

Find out more

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